Reading comprehension exercise

Six sentences have been removed from this article. Choose from A-G the one which fits each gap 1-6. There is one extra sentence.

My Job: fashion buyer

Lindsey Friedman, 27, is a product development manager at a major department store in the capital, she is in charge of buying men's branded casualwear.

What do I actually do? Well, I work with clothing suppliers to select and build the perfect range of clothes for our target customer. 1/... Much of the job involves building relationships with other suppliers, negotiating prices and making sure that deliveries of new stock arrive on time. I also work with department managers and a marketing team within the store to build my vision. 1

The most satisfying thing for me about the jib has been building my department into a credible fashion destination, as people often think of a department store as just a place to buy their cushions. 2/... When you've spent months planning a new collection, seeing it launched is so exciting. It's amazing when we take a gamble and include an unconventional look and it quickly takes off and sells really well. 2

On the other hand, it's my job to stay on top of the trends and create newness, so if I want to try out a new brand I have to drop an existing one, even if we've always had a long working relationship. 3/... The other side of the coin is that we're playing catch-up in fashion terms, and sometimes we get rejected too. There are cool brands of clothing that we'd like to sell that don't want to have too many accounts, so they won't let us stock them, unfortunately. 3

People sometime ask me what skills you need to be a successful buyer, and I reply that any type of fashion degree is a good way to start- mine was in textiles and clothing management. 4/... Obviously, you need to be really enthusiastic and motivated. You also have to be strategic, analytical and very well-organised, and you need to have a creative vision of what the perfect collection should look like. And you have to be good with figures, too, because you need to balance your budget. 4

The advice I would give to someone starting out in buying is join an executive training programme. 5/... For instance, you can go from being a buyer's administrative assistant to an assistant buyer to a junior buyer in just a few years. You also need to stay on top of the fashion industry and keep reading fashion magazines. Learn as much as you can about the product you are buying, and think carefully about the target customer you are selling to. 5

In general, the salaries are competitive and the career path is quite well defined. At the lower end, a buyer's administrative assistant might earn a little over the average national wage, but an experienced buyer might earn more than double that. You can move into the supply side, or work your way up to become a buying manager for a department store. 6/... Most of them, sadly, fail in their first year. 6

A) Many department stores run them, and if you can get a place on one it will move you up the ladder very quickly.

B) But whether or not you're a graduate in something like that the main thing is to get retail experience by working on the shop floor.

C) This has led to an overall drop in sales, a trend that isn't likely to be reversed for quite a while.

D) This means I need to find the right balance between choosing some unusual, on-trend fashion pieces, as well as other clothes, such as classic white T-shirts, which I know will sell really well.

E) That can be unpleasant, but you have to take the emotion out of it and remember that it's business.

F) Of course, not everyone can or wants to be promoted in that way, and lots of people dream of opening boutiques, but it's very risky.

G) Consequently, we've had to shout about the fact that we do stylish items of clothing, not just household goods like those.

Listening comprehension exercise

You will hear five different people talking about shopping experiences. For questions 1-5 choose from the list (A-H) what each speaker says. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

A. I bought more things than I had intended to.	
B. I bought an item that was good value for money.	
C. I did something that made someone else angry.	Speaker 1/
D. I asked the shop to make something specially for me.	Speaker 2/
E. I was shopping over the Internet for the first time.	Speaker 3/
F. I tried to get them to give me my money back.	Speaker 4/
G. I realised that the advertisement had not been truthful.	Speaker 5/
H. I was glad I had an alternative way of paying.	

Sentence transformation

For questions 1-6, complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first sentence, using the word given. Do not change the word given. You must use between two and five words, including the word given.

Before I bought that bike, I should've gone for a ride on it.
OUT
I wish _____ that bike before I bought it.

I think Sarah regrets spending all that money.
WISHES
I think Sarah _____ all that money.

They may search your luggage at the airport.
HAVE
You _____ at the airport.

I should have come home earlier last night.
STAYED
I wish _____ so late last night.

It's a pity there were no tickets left by the time we got there!
OUT
If only the tickets _____ by the time we got there!

If I buy one of those T-shirts, I'll ask them to send it by post.
GET
If I buy one of those T-shirts,
_____ by post.

The driver regrets not asking the garage to check his tyres.
HAD
The driver wishes he _____ by the garage.

Adjectives: learn a wider range to make your lexical range richer.

Instead of *interesting*, we might say *fascinating*

Match the adjectives in box A with the more extreme adjectives in box B.

A

angry	big	bright	pleasant	silly	strange	suitable	surprising

B

absurd	bizarre	breath-taking	delightful	furious
ideal	massive/huge	vivid		

A · B:

Which of these extreme adjectives mean 'very good'/ 'very bad'?

disgraceful	**dreadful**	**exceptional**	**fine**	**outstanding**	**severe**
stunning	**superb**	**tremendous**			

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Complete the sentences with extreme adjectives. In some cases, more than one answer is possible.

1. I was _____ when I realised my credit card had been used by someone else.
2. Alicia loves clothes with _____ colours, though I prefer plain ones.
3. I find it quite _____ that two kilos of apples cost less than one.
4. I'm fascinated by clothes, so being a fashion buyer is my _____ job.
5. There are some _____ views from the top of the mountain.
6. The firm made a _____ mistake by producing goods that nobody wanted.
7. There is a _____ water shortage following the very hot weather.
8. They sell some _____ clothes in that shop, and I wish I could afford them.

Writing – essay
(see also booklets 3 and 7)

In your English class you have been talking about the advantages and disadvantages of buying things on the Internet rather than getting them in the shops. Now, your English teacher has asked you write an essay.
Write an essay using all the notes and give reasons for your point of view.

Shopping online is better than going to the shops. Do you agree?
Notes:
1 which is cheaper
2 which is easier
3 your own idea

Write your essay in 140-190 words. You must use grammatically correct sentences with accurate spelling and punctuation in an appropriate style.

Remember to use:

- ✓ addition links
- ✓ contrast links
- ✓ adverbs of opinion or manner
- ✓ cause/effect expressions

Writing · essay: your answer (140-190 words)

Shopping online is better than going to the shops. Do you agree?

Grammar Reference

WISH – IF ONLY

Look at these sentences and answer the questions.

a) I wish I still had those 150 euros.
b) I wish I'd been more careful measuring the wall when I was at home.
c) I wish people would check they have enough money before they go shopping.

1 Which sentence expresses regret about the past?
2 Which sentence expresses a desire for change in the future, in this case something annoying that other people do?
3 Which sentence refers to a present situation we would like to be different?
4 In which sentence(s) could you use **if only** instead of I wish?

Correct the mistakes in these sentences:

1. I wish you were there with us last Friday.
2. We all wish scientists can find a new form of energy.
3. I wish I bought a red coat, not a grey one.
4. As soon as I heard his voice, I wished I didn't answer the telephone.
5. If only I would have known what was going to happen that night.
6. I wish you came to my house this evening and keep me company.
7. I wish I will have more time to spend with you.
8. Her first thought was: 'I wish I haven't decided to wear these shoes.'

HAVE – GET (causative)

Study these example sentences and answer the questions.

a) He had his suit made to measure.
b) We're going to get the house decorated.
c) Yesterday I had my phone stolen.

1 When we use have or get like this, do we do something ourselves?

2 Do we use have or get when something unpleasant is done to us?

3 What form of the verb do we use after *have* or *get* + noun (or pronoun)?

Complete the sentences with the correct form of *have* or *get* and these verbs.

clean	cut	deliver	repair	test	waste

1. It would have cost too much to ____ my shoes ____ so I bought a new pair.
2. I'm tired of ____ my time ____ by people phoning to try to sell me things.
3. If I have enough time, I ____ my hair ____ later today.
4. I must ____ my suit ____ before the interview next week.
5. Some sports fans believe that referees should ____ their eyes ____ more often.
6. Nowadays I order food over the Internet and ____ it ____ to my house.

Phrasal verbs - OUT

Use the context to work out the meaning of each of the meaning of the underlined phrasal verbs.

1. Those scarves are very popular with customers and we've run out of them completely.
2. Those old socks have got holes in! When are you going to throw them out?
3. We'll be out of petrol if we don't find a garage soon.
4. My brother's got a new bike and I want to try it out
5. I'm going to the bank to take out some money.
6. Our cat stays out at night, unless it's very cold.
7. Goods advertised as 'on offer' sometimes turn out to be poor value.
8. The prices are so low that everything will sell out in a few hours.

Complete the sentences with the correct form of these verbs + out.

back	breathe	cross	rush	shut	wear

1. The doctor asked me to _____ while she examined me.
2. Someone shouted 'Fire!' and people _____ of the shop, but it was a false alarm.
3. If you make a mistake, _____ it _____ and then write the correct word.
4. We have an agreement, so I hope they aren't going to _____ at the last minute.
5. The stadium was full for the big match and many people without tickets were _____ .
6. I've been on my feet shopping all day and I'm feeling _____ now.

Sentence structure: position of adverbs of manner and opinion

Correct the mistakes with adverb position in these sentences. There is only one mistake in each sentence, but in some cases more than one answer is possible.

1- Most local people do not speak **well** English.

2- I am a member of that club because I like **very much** doing sports.

3- I had read **carefully** the store's catalogue.

4- I swore that I would never do that again and they **thankfully** believed me.

5- The sightseeing tour gave us the opportunity to get to know **better** the city.

6- You can send **very quickly** an email to the seller.

7- I don't like cars, so I have **naturally** a bicycle.

8 -After a week, I learned that I hadn't **unfortunately** passed the examination.

Phrasal verbs with OUT · meanings

Work out the meaning of each underlined phrasal verb.

1. run out (of)
2. throw out
3. be out of
4. try out
5. take out
6. stay out
7. turn out
8. sell out